

INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Communication Skills

PRINCIPLES OF HOSPITALITY AND TOURISM

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of staff communication.
2. Organize information.
3. Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.
4. Write informational messages.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a team lead at SPLASH CANYON WATER PARK, an outdoor water park open during the summer. The park operations manager (judge) has asked you to improve how information is shared with employees.

SPLASH CANYON WATER PARK hires 300 seasonal employees each summer. Most are high school students who work part-time. Right now, information is shared through a bulletin board in the break room, emails and group text chats. Last weekend, several employees did not know about a new weather policy and gave guests incorrect information.

The park's busiest weekend, the Fourth of July, is two weeks away, and the park will stay open later than usual. The park operations manager (judge) wants you to explain how the park should organize and share information with employees, how supervisors should communicate with employees at the start of each shift, and what the message to employees about the holiday weekend should include.

You will present your ideas to the park operations manager (judge) in a role-play to take place in the manager's office. The park operations manager (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the park operations manager's (judge's) questions, the park operations manager (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Many of our employees do not check email. How will you make sure they see important messages?
2. How will we know employees understood the Fourth of July information?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of staff communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Organize information	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Explain the nature of effective verbal communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Write informational messages.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
					TOTAL SCORE	